

glorious entrance into Babylon, evidently written by some scribe under the Persian rule, while the so-called *Annals* is a concise historical summary of the events of the reign of Nabonidus until the accession of Cyrus, a paragraph being devoted to the events of each year.

Before passing on to the history of the advance of the Persians on Babylonia the following facts should be noticed. After Cyrus, king of the unimportant state of *Anšan*,⁵ according to the record of the *Annals*, had gotten possession of Media, the Persian prince finding himself transformed from the ruler of an insignificant province to the leader of a great kingdom, turned his eyes westward. Here Nabonidus the king of Babylon, who had at first regarded the defeat of his old enemies the Medes⁶ as a direct intervention of the gods, now becoming alarmed at the sudden rise of this new power concluded an offensive and defensive alliance with Lydia and Egypt, a league which should certainly have been sufficient to check the advance of the Persian forces. Lydia was compelled, however, by the swift movements of the enemy to defend herself without waiting for her allies. Cyrus, after totally routing the Lydian army at Pteria,⁷ proceeded directly against Sardis, the capital, which he captured without difficulty and there established his permanent headquarters in the northwest. The Persian king did not hasten at once against Babylonia, his second powerful rival, but, after settling affairs in Lydia and ap-

⁵ For the chronology of Cyrus' reign, his ancestry and kingdom, see Appendix I, note to Cyrus Cyl., l. 21 and to *Annals*, col. 2, l. 15.

⁶ The Medes during the reign of Nabonidus had attacked and destroyed the city of Harran and the temple of Sin. Cf. VR. 64. 12.

⁷ See Herodotus, i. 76. Note that Justin, Hist., i. 7, makes Cyrus begin the war with Babylon before that with Lydia, interrupting his conflict however, in order to conquer Cræsus who had offered aid to Babylon. Sulpicius, Hist., ii. 10, passed directly from the Median conquest to that of Babylonia.—Cræsus, king of Lydia, whom Cyrus captured, was according to Herodotus, i. 75, the brother-in-law of Astyages. Cyrus treated him kindly and gave him the city of Barene near Ecbatana as a residence, according to Ctesias, with five thousand riders and ten thousand bowmen as retinue.